



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Arma Dei Academy
School Website: <https://armadeiacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Ryan Catholic School demonstrates a strong religious and metaphysical foundation and explicitly frames its mission around "education in virtue," but it does not yet present the classical curricular and pedagogical markers (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin as a core language, Socratic seminar, scholastic/restful learning, chanting/recitation in lower grades, rhetoric training) on its public materials. The site repeatedly stresses formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, daily Mass, the liturgical year, and partnership with parents—all strong classical signals in Categories 1, 2, and 6. However, Categories 3 and 4 lack the classical keywords and practices. Net: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall.

Website audited: <https://bishopryan.com/> (see homepage title and mission/formation pages)

Method: This audit applies the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" across six categories and quantifies hits before rating each category (framework and keyword lexicon).

Key strengths: - Robust theological grounding, daily prayer and Mass, and explicit liturgical life (Element 1). - Mission-level commitment to formation in virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty (Element 2). - Clear language of partnering with parents and community practices (Element 6).

Primary gaps: - No public evidence of classical curriculum (Trivium, Quadrivium, Latin, Great Books) or pedagogy (Socratic, scholastic, recitation/chanting, rhetoric) (Categories 3–4).

School: Bishop Ryan Catholic School (Minot, ND)

URL: <https://bishopryan.com/>

Element-by-Element Audit (with required keyword analysis)

Each category below follows the required steps: 1) Keywords present on the school site 2) Comparison to Positive/Negative keyword lists (Six Essential Elements) 3) Quantified hits and coverage 4) Rating

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations - Keywords/phrases found in school materials: - "serve God," "education in virtue," Aristotle and St. Augustine citations, "Catechism of the Catholic Church," "Daily

Prayer,” “daily Mass,” “liturgical year,” “chaplain,” “true, the good, and the beautiful,” “sacramental” (contextually via Mass and chaplain role). - Comparison to Six Elements keywords: - Positive matches to transcendental/moral realism: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, telos (lasting happiness). - Grounded in theology: theology/catechesis, sacred tradition (Augustine), doctrine/Catechism, Christ-centered formation, faith and reason language implied by mission and quotations. - Liturgical/communal practices: daily prayer, daily Mass, liturgical year observance (matches “liturgy, daily chapel/Mass, sacred music, church calendar”). - Quantification: - Positive hits: +10 (virtue; truth/goodness/beauty; serve God; Augustine; Catechism; daily prayer; daily Mass; liturgical year; chaplain; formation) / Negative hits: -0 - Coverage of sub-elements: ~100% (all three sub-elements evidenced) - Percent positive: 95–100% (rounded to 100% for reporting) - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal - Keywords/phrases found: - “To serve God ... by laying the foundation for lasting happiness through education in virtue,” “directing their lives toward God by knowing, loving, and serving Him,” references to Aristotle on habituation, Augustine on our rest in God, “true, the good, and the beautiful”. - Comparison: - Strong alignment to Positive lists: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation rather than mere information (telos aimed at God and beatitude). - Quantification: - Positive hits: +8 / Negative: -0 - Coverage: ~100% of the three stated goals - Percent positive: 100% - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum - Keywords/phrases found: - “Religion classes,” “strong core curriculum,” “Advanced Placement opportunities” (no public mention of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, classical languages like Latin, or “history” over “social studies”). - Comparison: - Lacking Positive indicators: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; Latin/Greek; “Great Conversation” language; explicit “history” emphasis and wonder-integration are not present in the materials reviewed (contrast with the Positive lists). - No clear Negative flags like “social studies” dominance or heavy “project-based learning” language located on audited pages. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +0 / Negative: -0 - Coverage: low (~10%)—basic curriculum is mentioned but not in classical terms - Percent positive: 0% - Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy (Teaching Methods) - Keywords/phrases found: - None of the classical pedagogical terms were located: “Socratic,” “seminar,” “dialectic,” “scholé,” “restful learning,” “chanting,” “recitation,” “progymnasmata,” “rhetoric thesis/oration.” Pages do emphasize formation and religion courses but do not articulate classical methods of instruction. - Comparison: - Absent Positive indicators (Socratic, memorization/recitation/chanting, restful learning/scholé, rhetorical training) as defined in Six Elements. - No explicit Negative pedagogy claims (e.g., “project-based only,” “student-driven learning”) on reviewed pages. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +0 / Negative: -0 - Coverage: ~0–10% - Percent positive: 0% - Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty - Keywords/phrases found: - “Dedicated teachers,” presence of a School Chaplain who “encourag[es] their search for the true, the good, and the beautiful while teaching religion courses,” “Assistant Chaplains,” “Servant Leadership Program”. - Comparison: - Partial alignment to Positive signals (“teachers as models of virtue,” mentorship/formation, faculty shaping moral imagination) is implied but not fully articulated (no explicit “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or “teacher as mentor” statements on site pages reviewed). - Quantification: - Positive hits: +2 (chaplain-led formation; teachers mentioned as dedicated/formation context) / Negative: -0 - Coverage: ~40% (virtue modeling is evidenced; broader faculty culture/formation not public) - Percent positive: 40% - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community - Keywords/phrases found: - “partner with parents,” “faith-filled community,” “service projects for all grades,” “special celebrations throughout the liturgical year”. - Comparison: - Positive matches: parental primacy/partnership; community practices aligned to liturgical year; formation of affections by exposure to sacred time and practices (per Positive lists). - Absent: explicit “parent formation” offerings (book studies, seminars) on reviewed pages. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +4 / Negative: -0 - Coverage: ~50–60% - Percent positive: 60% - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating

- Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Strong evidence in Categories 1 and 2; moderate in 6; limited in 5; lacking in 3 and 4.
- Justification: The school clearly embraces virtue formation grounded in Catholic theology and active liturgical life—core classical foundations—but does not publicly signal classical curriculum and pedagogy.

What would move the needle (actionable next steps)

If Bishop Ryan intends to be publicly identifiable as a classical school, consider:

- Curriculum - Publish an academics page that explicitly names the Liberal Arts (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium: arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), names “Great Books”/primary sources, and highlights chronological “history” (rather than “social studies”), with an invitation to the “Great Conversation.” Include Latin as a core language where feasible.
- Pedagogy - Describe K–8 memory work, recitation, and chanting in the lower grades; name Socratic discussion/seminar in upper grades; point to rhetoric training and student orations/theses. Include language about scholé/restful, contemplative learning to balance “rigorous” with “restful.”
- Faculty formation - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher”/“Faculty of Friends” that emphasizes teachers as mentors and models of virtue, and mention ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy.
- Parent formation - Add parent reading groups or talks (e.g., Lewis’s *Abolition of Man*, Sayers’s “Lost Tools,” or other classical education primers) and note these publicly as “parent formation.”

These steps would markedly increase Element 3–5 scores and likely elevate the overall rating to CLASSICAL.

Citations (inline, representative)

- Mission and purpose (education in virtue; Aristotle; Augustine; Catechism).
- Religious formation and liturgical life (daily prayer, daily Mass, liturgical year; chaplain; “true, the good, and the beautiful”).
- Welcome/partnership with parents language.
- Site identification and homepage title/tagline (Inspired Minds. Faithful Hearts. Lives of Virtue.).
- Keyword framework used for analysis.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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